



For the audiophile in you

1.2 Music phones

One of the first multimedia functions to appear in mobile phones was a music player. Today, we have come a long way and your mobile phone can definitely replace your dedicated music player. Look out for phones with a 3.5-mm audio out jack, so you can use your favourite earphones with your mobile. Also, good music phones have a dedicated audio processing chip, dedicated hardware keys for changing the track or play/pause. A graphic equaliser would be a nice addition to satisfy the audiophile urge inside you.

Neat tricks such as Sony's SenseMe that automatically plays songs according to your mood and tempo, Shake control for changing tracks and Track Identification via applications such as Shazman can be useful additions. Battery life should be another

important consideration. You really don't want to run out of juice in the middle of that favourite track. A word of caution though, one area where music phones can't beat dedicated music players is the storage capacity. Most music phones saturate at 16 GB.

1.3 Gaming phones

Aimed towards teens, these phones offer a portable gaming platform which is sufficient enough to deserve a mention. With dedicated gaming D-pads, multiplayer (via Wi-Fi and Bluetooth), 3D rendering chips, accelerometer-based motion control combined with big titles such as *SIMS 3*, *Age Of Empire 3*, *NFS Undercover*, they have become a serious competitor for the Sony PSP and Nintendo's GameBoy. A physical screen size greater than 2 inches and a fast processor is a must if you want to enjoy the gaming experience. Oh yes, they can do one thing Sony's PSPs can't: make calls!



Phone or gaming console?